Nikos Vasileiadis

Software Engineering Manager · Leeds, UK (GMT - same timezone as Ireland) · British & Greek (EU) Citizen
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About Me

I started building websites as a teenager in northern Greece and turned a hobby into a 20-year career. After a decade of freelancing, teaching adults to use computers, and organising open-source conferences, I moved to Leeds in 2015 and found my way into engineering leadership - first through UX and Agile, then through platform teams and people management.

I'm currently an Engineering Manager at Utility Warehouse (FTSE 250), a UK multi-service provider of energy, broadband, mobile, and insurance - where I run platform services for the company's main website and lead a specialist engineering team. Across financial services, regulated utilities, global retail, and public sector work, I've combined technical depth with people development and organisational judgment. I review code daily, discuss architecture with my engineers, plan delivery, and work with stakeholders. I give engineers ownership of solutions and contribute directly to implementation where it helps the team deliver. I've introduced structured delivery in three resistant environments: a building society, a global brand agency, and a greenfield platform team.

Greek (EU) citizen - full right to work in Ireland and across the EU. Based in Leeds, same timezone as Dublin. Open to remote roles with Irish organisations.

What I'm About

- **People and teams** - leading with cultural intelligence, keeping people, growing them, and getting out of their way. DORA data for delivery health, Heartbeat surveys for wellbeing. Reorg communication on a cadence - including empty updates when there's nothing new. I measure what matters and act on it.
- **Technical direction** - reviewing architecture and PRs, challenging assumptions, and implementing software alongside people management; React, TypeScript, GraphQL, Contentful, and Kubernetes.
- **Platform operations** - keeping critical services running and stakeholders supported across 15+ engineering teams.
- **Design systems** - from co-building an open-source design system to leading enterprise-wide adoption across 20 teams.
- **Commercial sense** - a six-figure vendor portfolio across six platform services, CapEx/OpEx planning, vendor evaluation, and commercial literacy from sitting with compliance, marketing, data, and IT.
- **Documentation** - I inherited undocumented systems and built a culture of writing things down. Over 100 articles and counting.

Experience

Software Engineering Manager

Utility Warehouse (Telecom Plus PLC · FTSE 250 - multi-service provider of energy, broadband, mobile & insurance)
Jul 2023 - Present · United Kingdom · Remote

I manage the platform and content engineering team - the people responsible for uw.co.uk and the services that sit behind it. At peak I had 8 technical reports across three teams with separate backlogs - web, mobile, and design systems - with a Product Manager alongside. Three rounds of company restructuring later, we're a specialist core of 2. Everyone who wanted to stay, stayed. Nobody left by choice.

What the team and I have done:

- **Kept people and grew them.** Supported 3 promotions (Associate → Mid, Mid → Senior) with evidence-based cases - built on DORA delivery data and monthly Peakon Heartbeat surveys, acted on rather than just collected. Developed engineers who hadn't found the right home elsewhere in the organisation. People I mentored are now Engineering Managers, both inside and outside UW. The 100% retention wasn't luck - it was clarity, trust, and genuine career investment. Also involved in hiring 2 external engineers and 4 internal transfers.
- **Navigated restructurings.** When the organisation restructured - three times - I took responsibility for working out where the team should sit: mapping scope, talking to stakeholders, and building consensus. When mobile work entered our remit, I negotiated skill inbound - a Senior Engineer who already had the expertise - rather than stretching the existing team thin. And when a restructuring proposal would have merged the Design Systems team into another team, I made the case for keeping it separate - that team went on to enable the company-wide rebrand.

- **Built a documentation culture from nothing.** We inherited a CMS that nobody had documented in years. I started by mapping what existed - we called it "Archaeology" - and built up to over 100 articles of process and technical documentation. When we needed Kubernetes knowledge, I learned it first, trained the team, and documented it.
- **Modernised the platform alongside the rebrand (Oct 2025 - Apr 2026).** We moved from CMSv2 to CMSv3 while refreshing 522 pages. I reviewed architecture proposed by the engineers, implemented selected redesigned components, and helped establish the migration and coordinated launch approach. Raised risks early, secured temporary support through my manager, and helped defer tracking and experimentation work to protect the fixed date.
- **Improved the editing experience.** We reduced the component set, worked with content editors on feedback and validation, and observed fewer support requests after launch. The work connected technical debt reduction to the daily experience of three marketing teams.
- **Kept the platform running.** uw.co.uk operated against a 99.99% SLO with a single incident this year - resolved within hours - and <3s page loads on critical pages. The estate includes 522 pages, 3,157 media assets, 1,090 shortlinks, and 218 redirects. We support 8 content teams (33 users) and 15+ engineering teams across six platform services - Contentful CMS, Google Tag Manager, Snowplow, Mixpanel, Optimizely, and OneTrust.
- **Led Design System adoption.** The Hearth Design System reached 20 engineering and product teams (15 full, 5 partial), removing thousands of hours of duplicated engineering effort across the organisation.
- **Replaced the CMS.** The old CMS had no SLA, no SSO, and an ageing tech stack. I ran a 2-month evaluation across 10 vendors, shortlisted to 3, and we went with Contentful on an enterprise contract; most vendors simply couldn't offer enterprise-grade SLAs and support. The migration was zero-disruption; three marketing teams (~18 people) gained content scheduling and structured models. We also built the delivery platform around it - Next.js / React / TypeScript, running our own GraphQL API over Contentful's content APIs with request bundling, query optimisation, and on-demand content revalidation, a layer above what the vendor provides.
- **Kept going with a small team.** When the team became a specialist core of 2 engineers, I took on Product Manager and on-call responsibilities alongside my management role. We continued to deliver across 6 platform services without breaching the platform SLO, with full accountability for the uw.co.uk estate.

Lead Software Engineer

Utility Warehouse (Telecom Plus PLC · FTSE 250 - multi-service provider of energy, broadband, mobile & insurance)
May 2022 - Jul 2023 · United Kingdom · Remote

I joined as the founding engineer in a standalone team supporting marketing - no department, no established processes, no documentation. It was built to make use of my cross-functional experience in engineering, UX, and delivery.

- We started as three - me, a Product Manager, and an Associate Engineer - and stayed that way for a full year before we grew. I line-managed that engineer from May 2022: for my first year I reported directly to a VP of Engineering - no Head of Engineering in between - so the people responsibility was mine from the start, 14 months before the title arrived. Two external hires in May 2023 took us to five, and the founding Associate was promoted to Software Engineer a month after that - a promotion case I was asked to prepare and drive while I was still the Lead. Renamed Content Capability in Nov 2022, moved into Platforms in May 2023 - the first of three reorganisations the team would outlast.
- Set up a Scrum environment from scratch - structured backlog, predictable delivery, filling Product Manager gaps when needed. Mapped the legacy CMS through systematic discovery and wrote the team's foundational documentation.
- Led the vendor evaluation that resulted in UW adopting Contentful as its enterprise CMS.

Senior Full Stack Developer & Scrum Master

IMA-HOME
Jan 2020 - Apr 2022 · Leeds, UK · Hybrid

Combined frontend architecture with Scrum Master responsibilities for global clients including Adidas and MARS.

- Introduced Agile practices to an agency that had been running entirely on ad-hoc, fire-driven delivery. The result was measurable sprint velocity, predictable project allocation, and regular client demos - a step change in how the team worked.
- Architected the frontend for Royal Canin's (MARS) global web presence - a single design system serving 30+ countries including Japan and Saudi Arabia, with RTL and vertical reading direction support.

Senior Digital Developer & Scrum Master

Leeds Building Society (5th largest UK building society · £31B+ assets)
Oct 2018 - Jan 2020 · Leeds, UK · Hybrid

Maintained public-facing digital assets for the UK's 5th largest building society - a regulated financial services environment - while mentoring teams on code quality and UX standards.

- Introduced Agile and Scrum to the organisation for the first time - voluntary ways-of-working forums that grew championing into a parallel Scrum Master role, then a formal Interim SM appointment (Jun-Oct 2019) to stabilise Digital Transformation alongside external consultants.

UX Interface Developer & Scrum Master

Jadu
Jan 2017 - Oct 2018 · Leeds, UK · Hybrid

Designed UIs and developed features for an award-winning CMS used by UK Local Authorities, universities, and third-sector organisations. Everything was built with accessibility and W3C standards as non-negotiables.

- Co-created **Pulsar** - an open-source UX and Interface Design System powering the Jadu Continuum Platform. This is where my design systems specialism started, and I'm still proud of it.
- Owned the full feature lifecycle - going out to council offices and universities for contextual research, writing up findings, building mockups, running usability tests, and shipping to production. One of three product-area leads, each responsible for their own domain.
- Gained hands-on Agile leadership through a rotating Scrum Master model.

Early Career, Teaching & Community

Oct 2005 - Dec 2016 (11 years)

The foundation years. Provincial northern Greece - Xanthi, where I grew up; Serres, where I studied: no tech industry to join and, after 2010, barely an economy. I built the career anyway - client by client - and led long before anyone gave me a title for it.

- **Web development & freelancing (2005-2015):** Delivered 40+ web projects across Greece and internationally - from local non-profits and bands to a Bitcoin job board for a client in California. Managed end-to-end client relationships, set up proper billing structures (40/40/20 payment terms), and coordinated with distributed teams. Started at 15 with my first website; bought my first domain in 2005.
- **Teaching & mentorship (2006-2012):** Earned a Certified Training Professional qualification and spent a year teaching ECDL to adult learners. Privately tutored a student in programming and hardware - that student went on to earn a BSc and MSc in Manchester and is now an Engineering Manager. One of my proudest outcomes.
- **Community & civic technology (2008-2014):** Co-founded the Serres Linux Users Group, organised FOSSCOMM 2012 (a 350-person national volunteer-powered conference), and managed the digital presence for UNESCO Serres, the local Natural History Museum, and community organisations. This community work directly shaped everything I went on to do in Leeds - GDG, IxDF, NUX.
- **UK agency work (2015-2016):** Relocated to Leeds. Built responsive e-commerce for global brands (Vivienne Westwood) and focused on frontend performance.

Community & Volunteering

Community organising has been a constant throughout my career - from Greece to Leeds.

Mentor, WRK digital *(Feb 2023-Present)*: Part of a peer mentoring network that spans EMs, Heads of Engineering, VPs, and CTOs.

Mentor, School of Code *(Aug 2023-Jan 2024)*: Supported people making their first steps into the industry.

Lead Organiser, Google Developers Group Leeds *(Jan 2019-Mar 2020)*: Revived an inactive chapter and ran conferences, workshops, and meetups. The highlight was a one-day conference in November 2019 with UK and international speakers - entirely volunteer-powered.

Education & Executive Development

Saïd Business School, University of Oxford Oxford Emerging Leaders Programme (Blended) · Executive Education · Sep 2026-Present (in progress, first cohort)

13 weeks of live online learning followed by a three-day Oxford immersion. Developing systems thinking, stakeholder influence, strategic alignment, and change leadership through a playbook applied to a live organisational challenge.

International University of Greece - Serres Campus
Undergraduate studies in Informatics Engineering, 2007-2012 (degree not completed). Continued into full-time freelance work during the Greek economic crisis.

Credentials

AI Leader: Generative AI & Agentic AI for Leaders & Founders · Udemy, Mar 2026
Team Topologies Distilled · Team Topologies Academy, Oct 2023
Mental Health First Aid Champion · MHFA England & UK Health Security Agency, 2022-2023
Professional Scrum Product Owner I (PSPO I) · Scrum.org, Aug 2021
Professional Scrum Master I (PSM I) · Scrum.org, Jun 2019

Full credentials list available on the Credentials page.